

mineral A group of chemicals forming a solid that occurs in nature, such as crystals

mountain A large landform that rises above the surrounding land, usually with a peak. A mountain is usually higher than a hill

polar Areas near the North and South Poles

pollution Waste that has been dumped in water, in the air, or on land. Pollution can have a negative effect on the environment

population The number of people living in a country or smaller area, such as a city or a town

rainforest An area with heavy rainfall, allowing lots of trees and other plants to grow. Many are also very hot

river A large body of water flowing in a channel to the sea, a lake, or another river

rock A group of minerals, forming a solid that is found underground or on the surface of the Earth

rural In the countryside. The opposite of urban



Atacama Desert, South America



season Yearly cycles of change that affect the weather, animals, and plants. The four seasons are spring, summer, autumn, and winter

seismograph A machine that measures earthquakes

snow Ice crystals that fall from clouds and stick together to form snowflakes

solar system The collection of eight planets that revolve around our Sun

storm Strong winds, between gale and hurricane force, of 103–121 km/h (64–75 mph)

tectonic plate Giant rocky plates that make up the Earth's crust

temperate An area or a climate with mild temperatures

tornado A thin spiral of air spinning at high speed around an area of extremely low air pressure. Wind speeds may be higher than 320 km/h (200 mph)

tropical An area or a climate with hot temperatures

tundra A cold, treeless area near the North and South Poles, where soil remains frozen for most of the year

urban A built-up area, such as a city or a large town. The opposite of rural

volcano Where hot magma breaks through the Earth's crust with great pressure

weathering The cracking of rocks by weather, plants, or chemicals

wetland Land made up of marshes or swamps